TOWING ARRANGEMENTS ON TANKERS

THE MARITIME SAFETY COMMITTEE,

MSC 63/23/Add.1

RECALLING Article 28(b) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization concerning the functions of the Committee,

RECALLING ALSO that the Assembly, at its thirteenth session, when adopting resolution A.535(13) concerning Recommendation on emergency towing requirements for tankers, requested the Committee to keep the Recommendation under review, in particular in respect to new towing concepts which may be introduced and to report as necessary to the Assembly,

NOTING that tankers, including oil tankers, gas carriers and chemical tankers, in emergencies such as complete mechanical breakdowns, may need to be

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NOTING that tankers, including oil tankers, gas carriers and chemical tankers, in emergencies such as complete mechanical breakdowns, may need to be towed out of danger, and that technologically advanced towing arrangements have been developed since the adoption of resolution A.535(13), whose provisions need revision to incorporate new towing concepts,

NOTING ALSO that the new regulation V/15-1 of the International Convention for the Safety of Life at Sea, 1974, as adopted by the Committee in May 1994, requires that all tankers of not less than 20,000 tonnes deadweight shall be fitted with an emergency towing arrangement, the design and construction of which shall be approved by the Administration based on the Guidelines developed by the Organization,

HAVING CONSIDERED the recommendation made by the Sub-Committee on Ship Design and Equipment at its thirty-seventh session,

1. ADOPTS the Guidelines for Emergency Towing Arrangements on Tankers, the

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Design and Equipment at its thirty-seventh session,

1. ADOPTS the Guidelines for Emergency Towing Arrangements on Tankers, the text of which is set out in the Annex to the present resolution and which supersedes resolution A.535(13);

2. RECOMMENDS that all Governments concerned take appropriate steps to implement the Guidelines.

WIl648n/EWP

RESOLUTION MSC.35(63)

(adopted on 20 May 1994)

ADOPTION OF GUIDELINES FOR EMERGENCY

TOWING ARRANGEMENTS ON TANKERS MSC 63/23/Add.l

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1 PURPOSE

ANNEX

GUIDELINES FOR EMERGENCY TOWING

ARRANGEMENTS ON TANKERS

1.1 Under regulation V/15-1 of the 1974 SOLAS Convention, as amended by resolution MSC.31(63) in 1994, new and existing tankers of 20,000 tonnes deadweight and above shall be fitted with an emergency towing arrangement, the design and construction of which shall be approved by the Administration, based on the Guidelines developed by the Organization.

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the design and construction of which shall be approved by the Administration, based on the Guidelines developed by the Organization.

1.2 The present Guidelines are intended to provide standards for the design and construction of emergency towing arrangements which Administrations are recommended to implement.

1.3 For existing tankers fitted with the emergency towing arrangements in accordance with resolution A.535(13), the existing towing arrangements forward of the ship may be retained, but the towing arrangements aft of the ship should be upgraded to comply with the requirements of the present Guidelines.

2 REQUIREMENTS FOR THE ARRANGEMENTS AND COMPONENTS

2.1 General

The emergency towing arrangements should be so designed as to facilitate salvage and emergency towing operations on tankers primarily to reduce the risk of pollution. The arrangements should at all times be capable of rapid deployment in the absence of main power on the ship to be towed and easy

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risk of pollution. The arrangements should at all times be capable of rapid deployment in the absence of main power on the ship to be towed and easy connection to the towing vessel. Figure 1 shows arrangements which may be used as reference.

2.2 Towing components

The major components of the towing arrangements should consist of the following:

Forward of ship"' Aft of ship

Pick-up gear

Towing pennant

Chafing gear

Fairlead

Strongpoint

Roller pedestal

optional

optional

Yes

Yes

Yes

Yes

See paragraph 3.1.4.

W/1648n/EWP

Yes

Yes

Depending on design

Yes

Yes

Depending on design

Strength requirements

Yes

Yes

Yes

Yes

RESOLUTION MSC.35(63)

(adopted on 20 May 1994)

ADOPTION OF GUIDELINES FOR EMERGENCY

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2.3 Strenqth of the towinq components

2.3.1 Towing components as specified in 2.2 for strength should have a

working strength of at least 1,000 kN for tankers of 20,000 tonnes

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